functioning

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was

immediately rectified. Meanwhile, the down-range station asked for a “Hold”. In another few seconds, multiple Holds were necessitated, resulting in irreversible internal power consumption. We had to abort the launch. The missile had to be opened up to replace the on-board power supplies. A weeping Nagaraj, by now informed about the tragedy in his family, met me and promised that he would be back within three days. The profiles of these courageous people wil never be written about in any history book, but it is such silent people on whose hard work generations thrive and nations progress. Sending Nagaraj off, I met my team members who were in a state of shock and sorrow. I shared my SLV-3 experience with them. “I lost my launch vehicle in the sea but recovered successful y. Your missile is in front of you. In fact you have lost nothing but a few weeks of rework.” This shook them out of their immobility and the entire team went back to retrieve the subsystems and re-charge them.